



Photography: Jiten Gandhi

Price no bar

The entry level cellphone market is all set to explode with loads of new brands and extensive feature lists at never seen before prices. We help you choose from 30 options.

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Ten million mobile phone subscribers are added to the Indian cellphone market every month. A major chunk of this number is thanks to the no-frills entry level handsets, which are great for making and receiving calls and SMS. The

importance of cellphones in our lives cannot be underestimated.

Increased competition among the handset manufacturers has resulted in entry-level cellphones getting features that were only seen in high-end phones just a year back. Some phones have additional features like camera, FM etc. We got our hands on close to 30 entry-level cell

phones from a range of manufacturers. Sony Ericsson did not wish to participate in this comparison test, a disturbing trend we've noticed since last year. LG displayed a marked lack of interest in sending us phones, but eventually managed to get a couple of devices at the last moment, one of which is featured briefly here. Since our last entry-level cell-

phones comparison test, we came across a lot of trends.

The rise of multi SIM phones for one. Due to the increasing use of cellphones at workplace and home, it has become the need of the hour to have two separate numbers for the work and personal use. Till some months back you had to keep switching your SIM cards or use two different phones. But thanks to dual-SIM enabled phones, that problem has been addressed.

The definition of entry-level cell phones has undergone a wealth of changes. All the phones that we got for the comparison test had colour displays, except one. Monochrome displays are slowly but surely dying out. The phones we got also had camera